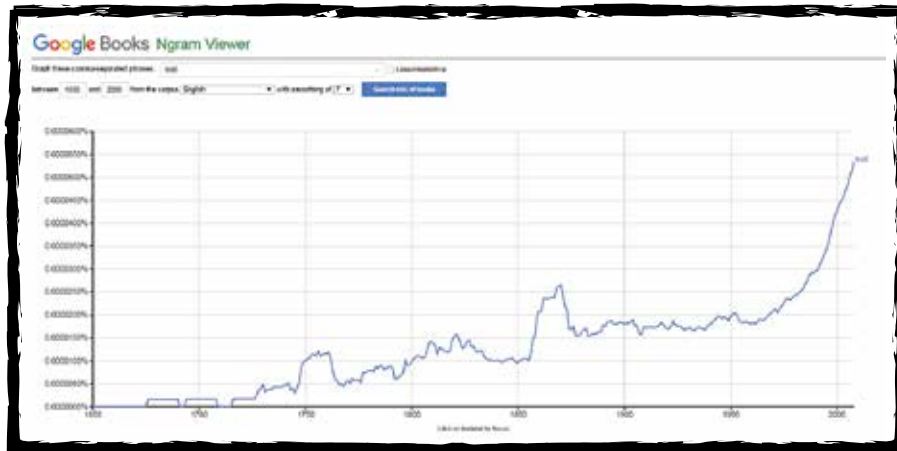


We will, however, overreach a bit, and try and broaden the definition of, let's call it "troll-like behaviour" and try and look at it from an evolutionary perspective, to figure out whether this is really a recent

security breach, as currently Trump is the leading Republican candidate in the run up to the US presidential elections. However, all anonymous had really done was to collect information already in the

Not all trolls are malicious, or trying to cause trouble even. Another way of trolling someone is to feign ignorance, or purposely act stupid so as to get a laugh, and to cause some people to get frustrated. This kind of troll is perfectly fine with being laughed at, in fact, he/she counts on it. An example here is Kenneth McCarthy, a writer for Comedy Central. Kenneth (Ken M) actually started off on the internet like all of us. In an interview to Upvoted, he recounted how he used to leave sincere comments on news articles, but never received any rational replies. Without even knowing what trolling was, he started playing dumb, in his own way of pushing the boundaries of how stupid he could be in the comments and still get people to reply to him, and take him seriously. Soon, he was an internet sensation and had a fan following.

Even this writer was fooled once while writing a dmystify about nuclear weapons, where someone had inserted false information into a Wikipedia page, which was then picked up by a few smaller sites as a story of interest, and



Popularity of the word troll showing up in books over the past 300 years or so

flare-up of human behaviour, or whether there is more to it than meets the eye.

In a sense, this article essentially aims to trace troll-like behaviour backwards. We're no biologists, and we are certainly not evolutionary biologists. Thus we apologise in advance for using the terms "evolution" or "natural selection" in as loose ways in which those terms can be used. We are merely seeking to find a pattern (one which very possibly may exist only in our minds) through all of complicated life, in order to better try and understand this organism called a troll. Let's start with more recent and famous troll events and work our way backwards in time.

FAMOUS RECENT ACTS

Now here's where it gets insane. There are just so many examples on the internet of people being trolled, we don't even know where to begin.

Let's start with the group Anonymous. Perhaps the most famous yet anonymous group of all time, the hacker combine recently "fooled" Donald Trump, the Secret Service and the FBI, by claiming to have "hacked" Donald Trump's personal information, and then proceeded to post it publicly online. Now obviously this was considered a security threat and a

public domain and repost it as hacked information. (Read more about it here: <http://dgit.in/AnonDrumpf>)

Actually, anonymous itself is set up to be a haven for trolls. This is because most trolls like to stay anonymous, and that's why the internet is the ideal place to do so, because it's really easy to keep your real identity hidden. So long as you don't break any laws, tracers like the IP address you use cannot be demanded by authorities or others from the services you're using online. This means that you can pretty much say anything you want online, and only risk getting banned, blocked or having your account terminated, which in today's day and age of free accounts, is no big loss. Thus, when someone claims to belong to the group Anonymous, you really cannot tell if they are or aren't, because by it's own definition, it's a decentralised group.



A typical troll by Ken M, who is very popular these days